MODULE HANDBOOK

MGT4952

Strategy and Innovation

Department of Management, Leadership and Organizations

Faculty of Business

Module Leader: Dr Sreejith Balasubramanian

Semester 1 2026/2027

Credits: 15 credits

Duration of the module: 12 weeks

Intake: ***September***

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- a Word document with enlarged type — sent by email
- printed copy with enlarged type
- printed copy on non-white paper

Other formats may be possible. We will do our best to respond promptly. To help us, please be as specific as you can about the information you require and include details of your disability.

Welcome to Middlesex University Dubai!

Module Leader: Dr Sreejith Balasubramanian

Welcome to MGT4952 Strategy and Innovation. I hope you find this module both intellectually engaging and directly relevant to your professional and leadership practice.

Strategy is fundamentally about making choices: understanding a changing environ-ment, determining where and how an organisation can create value, developing appropriate strategic options, and translating those choices into action. Throughout this module, you will critically explore strategic management and innovation through con-temporary business challenges. You will apply strategic frameworks and evidence to real-world organisational contexts and consider how strategies can be effectively implemented and adapted over time. The module is designed not simply to introduce strategic tools, but to develop your strategic thinking, judgement and ability to communicate evidence-based recommendations that can support decision-making in complex organisational environments.

This Module Handbook introduces the module, its learning outcomes and requirements, and should be used alongside the Programme Handbook and the information available to all students on MyLearning: https://mdx.mrooms.net/course/view.php?id=45668

Note: Students must also refer to the Campus Guide on the Middlesex University Dubai website, which sets out key information relating to campus services, facilities, student support, policies, procedures, and behavioural expectations. It should be read in conjunction with this Module Handbook, the Programme Handbook, the University Regulations, and the information available on MyLearning and MyMDX. Together, these documents set out the academic, administrative, and regulatory requirements applicable to your studies and form part of the framework governing your rights, responsibilities, and conduct as a student. Students are expected to familiarise themselves with, and comply with, the requirements and policies contained within these documents.

MyMDX App and Web Portal

The MyMDX App and Web Portal provide students with access to essential information and resources, including timetables, attendance records, campus news and events, live updates, student support services through AskMDX, and Middlesex University Dubai social media channels. Access is available using the student's **@studentmdx.ac** credentials.

The web portal can be accessed at https://mdxcentral.mdx.ac.ae, while the mobile app can be downloaded from the Google Play Store and Apple App Store by searching for **MDX Dubai**. User guides for the Student Portal and mobile app are available for further guidance on using these platforms.

Module Teaching Team

Staff Name	Photo	University Contact Details	Advice & Feedback Hours	Role Description
Dr Sreejith Balasubramanian Associate Professor in Operations and Supply Chain & Chair, Office of Research		Email: s.balasubramanian@mdx.ac.ae Telephone: 043678100	By email appointment	Module Leader
Dr Nitin Simha Vihari Poluru		Room number G-05, Block 17, DKP Email N.Poluru@mdx.ac.ae Telephone number: +971 (0) 4361 2895	Mondays 2:00 PM-3:00 PM during teaching weeks, online by appointment.	Module Tutor
Sony Sreejith		Email: S.Sreejith@mdx.ac.ae Telephone: 971 4 367 8100 Block 15, Room 105	By email appointment	Senior Lecturer-Business Head of International Foundation Programme

Dr Michael Cardoso		Room number: Block 16, Faculty offices, Third Floor Email: M.Cardoso@mdx.ac.ae Telephone number: +971 (0)43693971	Mondays 12:30 PM-1:30 PM during teaching weeks, online by appointment.	Module Tutor
Dr Gulzhan Rysbekova/		Email: g.rysbekova@mdx.ac.ae Phone: +971 4 367 8100	By email appointment	Senior Lecturer
Baraa Yousuf		Email: b.yousuf@mdx.ac.ae	By email appointment	Visting Faculty MBA Operations & Supply Chain Management Pathway

Communication with the Team

Students are required to use their Middlesex email address when contacting members of staff to avoid emails being caught in University spam filters. Students are also expected to always include their full name, student number, programme name, year of study, and module details when contacting staff.

Students are expected to respond to emails from staff within three working days (i.e. excluding weekends, public holidays, and University closure days) and allow staff the same period of time (three working days) to respond to their queries. Whilst staff may occasionally choose to respond to emails outside of normal working hours (Monday to Friday, 9 AM to 5 PM GST), this should not be expected as standard. If students do not hear back from a member of staff within the three working day timeframe, sending a reminder email is encouraged, but not sooner. Students may also raise their query with a different member of staff, such as their Campus Programme Leader/Coordinator. Contact details for these members of staff can be found within the MDX Central App. If a staff member is away from work, they may have set up an "out of office" automated email that provides instructions on how queries can be addressed in their absence; therefore, students are expected to carefully read any such messages.

Students are expected to contact their Module Leader/Coordinator(s) and/or the Campus Programme Leader/Coordinator if they are absent for any period of time and are unable to attend scheduled teaching sessions.

Overall module and course feedback can also be given to the Student Voice Leader for their programme which will be included in Programme Voice Group (PVG) meetings.

Note: Students are expected to check the Middlesex University Dubai website, MyMDX App and MDX Dubai App regularly during the semester for any other notifications or announcements. Attempt to look for basic answers to questions (e.g. by using MyMDX, Dubai Campus Guide or MDX Dubai App) before contacting lecturers or staff.

For all queries that don't relate to your programme of study (e.g. fees, wellbeing, accommodation, IT issues, etc.) you should directly contact Campus Central via AskMDX on the MDX Dubai App rather than your lecturers. This will help ensure you get a response more quickly.

Take time to write polite emails/ queries (as you would in professional employment) in all communications with staff. This should include use of a clear subject line to indicate the subject of your message and previous emails on the conversation thread.

1. Module Overview

1.1 Aims

This module aims to develop your practical understanding of strategic decision-making and innovation management, and to lay the foundation for ongoing development of strategic thinking through-out your professional or entrepreneurial careers. In this module you will critically examine the challenges and opportunities presented by tech-nological advancements, market shifts, and global trends. You will also examine the role of innovation in crafting, analysing, and

executing business strategies, and how innovation affects firms' performance within evolving markets and industries. Through this examination, this module will prepare you with the capabilities to formulate and implement strategies that drive organisational success and adaptation in rapidly changing environments.

1.2 Learning Outcomes

LO Number	*Description*	*Attribute*
LO1	Critically evaluate the theory and practice of strategic management and innovation within various organisational contexts and demonstrate the ability to apply this understanding to real-world business scenarios.	Knowledge
LO2	Analyse the impact of global trends on strategic management and innovation, recognising the significance of ethical, social, and technological factors in shaping business strategies.	Knowledge
LO3	Effectively apply a wide array of strategic analysis and innovation management tools and frameworks, and critically interpret the outcomes of utilising them to address real-world business challenges.	Skills
LO4	Develop and communicate effectively the output of analyses, demonstrating advanced skills in communication and teamwork.	Skills

1.3 Syllabus

The module will cover the following areas:

- Foundations of strategy and innovation, including strategic purpose, value creation and the role of strategic management in contemporary organisations.
- Analysis of the external business environment, including macro-environmental trends, industry structure, competition, stakeholders and strategic leadership.
- Internal strategic analysis, including organisational resources and capabilities, core competences, value creation, culture and structure.
- Business-level strategy, competitive advantage and business models.
- Corporate and international strategy, including diversification, internationalisation, growth and collaborative strategies.
- Strategic decision-making, development and evaluation of strategic options, and strategy selection under conditions of complexity and uncertainty.
- The nature, sources and patterns of innovation, including product, process, and business-model innovation.
- Innovation strategy, including industry dynamics, platforms, ecosystems, collaboration and approaches to protecting innovation.
- Strategy implementation, including organisational design, governance, people, change, resource allocation and management of innovation.

- Evaluation of strategic performance using evidence, data and feedback to sup-port strategic learning and adaptation.
- Strategy communication and the development of evidence-based recommendations for senior organisational decision-makers.
- Critical reflection on strategic thinking, decision-making and the development of professional practice.

1.4 Learning and Teaching

A range of teaching and learning methods will be used. On-campus seminars, workshops, and labs utilise a variety of interactive practice-based activities to stimulate exchange of ideas and development of critical thinking, analysis, communication and problem-solving skills. Activities such as Q&A sessions, polls, quizzes, games, simulations, use of software, role playing, guest speakers and case studies are used to develop in-depth and practice-based knowledge and understanding to challenge students to seek innovative solutions to business problems through collaboration, research and analysis.

Reading lists guide student reading of relevant selected textbooks, academic journals, case studies and company and industry documents.

Scheduled teaching: 48 Hours

Independent study: 152 Hours

1.5 Learning Planner

Learning week	Lecture / Seminar	Readings & Learning Materials	Mapped Learning Outcome(s) and Assessments
September 14 Week 0	Introduction to the module & handbook Concept checking and review Delivery mode face to face		LO1; CW1 & CW2 orientation
Week 1	What is Strategy? Strategic Purpose and Internal Analysis. Strategy, strategic purpose, vision and mission; levels and elements of strategy; Internal analysis: resources, capabilities, RBV, VRIO and value chain	Chapter 1 – Volberda, Chapter 1 - Exploring Strategy (Johnson), Rothaermel (Chapter 1, 2.2)	LO1, LO2, LO3; CW1 & CW2
Week 2	External Analysis: Business Environment and Competition. Macro-environment, PESTEL, industry structure, Five Forces, markets, stakeholders and competitors.	Chapter 5&6 – Exploring Strategy (Johnson), Rothaermel (Chapter 2.1), Chapter 5&6 - Volberda	LO1, LO2, LO3; CW1
Week 3	Core Strategic Position, Value, Business Models and Competitive Advantage. Strategic positioning; cost leadership, differentiation and focus; value creation; business models; connecting external and internal analysis.	Chapter 4,5&6 – Exploring Strategy (Johnson), Rothaermel (Chapters 4), Chapter 16 - Volberda	LO1, LO2, LO3; CW1
Week 4	Strategic Thinking and Decision-making. Internationalization, M&As, market entry, Alliances and Collaborations	Chapter 8,9,16 (Johnson), Chapter 14 (Volberda), Chapters 8, 9, 10 (Rothaermel)	LO1, LO2, LO3, LO4; CW1 & CW2

Week 5	Innovation and Strategic Change. Sources, types and patterns of innovation; product vs process; radical vs incremental innovation; translating creativity into innovation; Blue Ocean Strategy; collaboration and strategic change. Formative work-in-progress feedback.	Chapter 1, 2, 3 (Schilling), Chapter 7.1, 7.2, 7.6 Strategic Management (Rothaermel), Chapter 15 (Volberda)	LO1, LO2, LO3; CW1 & CW2
Week 6	Strategy Implementation. Structure, governance, portfolio management and people; organising and implementing strategic and innovation initiatives; alignment between strategic choice and organisational design.	Chapter 3, 11, 14 (Volberda), Chapter 4, 5 & 6 – Exploring Strategy (Johnson), Rothaermel (Chapters 4)	LO1, LO2, LO3; CW1 & CW2
Week 7	Performance, Feedback and Strategic Adaptation; emergent strategy; data/evidence and AI-supported strategic analysis. Strategy communication. Mock presentations and formative feedback.	Chapter 11.5, 11.6 & 12.4 (Volberda)	LO1, LO2, LO3, LO4; CW1 & CW2
Week 8	Assessment 1: Group Strategic Analysis Presentations and Q&A. Module synthesis and reflection.	Group presentations; module materials and readings	LO1–LO4; CW1 summative; CW2 reflection

** The default mode of delivery for teaching sessions is face to face. Any alternative mode of delivery will be explicitly indicated where required by programme, module, accreditation, regulatory, national or other approved requirements expressly communicated by the University.*

1.6. Assessment Scheme

The module uses a combination of collaborative strategic analysis and individual critical reflection to assess students' ability to apply, evaluate and integrate strategy and innovation concepts at postgraduate level.

The assessment strategy comprises two components: a Group Strategic Analysis Presentation (60%), in which students critically analyse an organisation and develop evidence-based strategic and innovation recommendations (Individual performance within the group project is considered when awarding marks) and an Individual Reflection (40%), in which students critically reflect on how their understanding of strategy and innovation has developed across the module. Formative feedback opportunities are embedded throughout the module to support students in developing both assessments.

1.7 Learning Resources

Essential

Volberda, H. W., Hollen, R. M. A., Pereira, J. R., Sidhu, J. S., & Heij, K. (2024). Strategic management: From confrontation to transformation. SAGE Publications.

Rothaermel, F.T., (2024), Strategic Management: Concepts and Cases, 6th Edition, New York, NY: McGraw-Hill.

Recommended

Schilling, M.A. (2023) Strategic Management of Technological Innovation, Seventh Edition, New York, NY: McGraw Hill.

Johnson, G., R. Whittington, P. Regner, K. Scholes, and D. Angwin (2023). Exploring Strategy, 13th edition, London, Pearson Education.

Journals:

- California Management Review
- London Business School Review
- Long Range Planning
- Harvard Business Review
- MIT Technology Review
- Sloan Management Review
- Strategic Management

Journal

Websites:

- www.bain.com Bain Management Consultants
- www.theccc.org.uk - Committee on Climate Change
- www.fhi.ox.ac.uk – Future of Humanity Institute, Oxford University
- www.mckinsey.com – McKinsey Management Consultants Electronic Data-bases: Mintel Fame (UK Companies) Statista
- Access Chartered Management Institute resources using your University cre-dentials: https://mdx.md.cmi.org.uk/

1.8 Research Ethics

The teaching, learning, assessment and research activities undertaken in this module have been considered and are not likely to require ethical approval.

However, please seek advice if undertaking the module entails carrying out any research activities involving human participants, human data, animals/animal products, precious artefacts, materials or data systems or social media. If you submit work that includes data gathered from or about people, this may be treated as academic misconduct and could lead to fail grade being awarded.

Research ethics approval seeks to ensure all research is designed and undertaken according to certain principles of ethical research. These include:

1. Primary concern must be given to the **safety, welfare and dignity** of participants, researchers, colleagues, the environment and the wider community
2. Consideration of **risks** should be undertaken before research commences with the aim of minimising risks to those involved – i.e. human participants or animal subjects, colleagues, the environment and the wider community, as well as actual or potential risks to those directly or indirectly affected by the research.
3. **Informed consent** should be freely given by participants, and only by a trained person when collecting or analysing human tissue.
4. Respect for the **privacy, confidentiality and anonymity** of participants
5. Consideration of the rights of **people who may be vulnerable** (by virtue of perceived or actual differences in their age, social status, ethnic origin, gender, mental capacities, or other such characteristics) who may be less competent or able to refuse to give consent to participate
6. For participants below the age of 18, parental consent must be obtained prior to the study.
7. Researchers have a responsibility to the general public and to their profession; as such they should balance the anticipated benefits of their research against **potential harm, misuse or abuse** which must be avoided
8. Researchers must demonstrate the highest standards of **ethical conduct and research integrity**. They must work within the limits of their skills, training and experience, and refrain from exploitation, dishonesty, plagiarism, infringement of intellectual property rights and the fabrication of research results. They should declare any actual or potential conflicts of interest, and where necessary take steps to resolve them.
9. When using human tissues for research, the UK's Human Tissue Act and Human Tissue Authority (HTA) requirements must be met. Please contact the relevant designated person (DP) in your department or the HTA Designated Individual (DI).

10. Research should **not involve any illegal activity**, and researchers must comply with all relevant laws

You can apply for research ethical approval using the Middlesex University Dubai Ethics Form. The relevant forms, templates and guidance on the approval process can be obtained from the module folder on MyMDX.

Your module coordinator can provide further guidance. Additionally, documents can be found through the following link: https://bit.ly/35Zp7MZ

2. Assessment

2.1 Formative Assessment

Formative assessments help show you and us that you are learning and understanding the material covered in this course and allow us to monitor your progress towards achieving the learning outcomes for the module. Although formative assessments do not directly contribute to the overall module mark, they do provide an important opportunity to receive feedback on your learning.

Formative assessment	Deadline
Ongoing formative feedback and feed forward will be provided in seminars/workshops during in-class practical exercises	Ongoing
Structured formative assessment will be used to provide feedback approximately halfway through the module and in a scheduled session in the teaching programme shortly before the submission deadline	Draft Feedback (Week 5 onwards) Mock Presentation – Week 7

2.2 Summative Assessment

Summative assessment is used to check the level of learning on the course. It is summative because it is based on accumulated learning during the course. The point is to ensure that students have met the learning outcomes for the course and are at the appropriate level. It is the summative assessment that determines the grade that you are awarded for the module.

Summative assessment	Weighting	Draft Feedback opportunity	Deadline	Feedback
Group Strategic Analysis Presentations	60%	Week 5-7	Week 8	Via MyLearning
Individual Reflection	40%	Week 5-7	Week 8	Via MyLearning

In order to pass this module, you need to pass the overall assessment tasks with a minimum grade of *16* or equivalent.

Before submitting your work, ensure all sources are accurately referenced and that spelling, punctuation, and grammar are correct. Written assessments evaluate technical proficiency in English; details are outlined in the assessment marking criteria and the University Grade Criteria Guide.

Reasonable adjustments will be made for those students who have a declared disability/specific learning condition which would affect performance in this area.

Reassessment for this module normally takes place in the following way:

If students fail the module (fail grades are 17, 18, 19, 20 with an overall mark between 0% and 39%) they are eligible for a re-sit. Students will be re-examined in the assessed component(s), which they have failed (please note that this can be a different assessment task). Information on what element to re-sit will be made available on the module's MyMDX site approximately two weeks after the module results have been published on MyMDX. You will be notified about reassessment dates in a timely manner.

Normally you would be entitled to only one reassessment opportunity if you don't pass at first attempt.

2.3 Assessment Brief

Part 1 – 60%

Assessment Title	Group Strategic Analysis Presentation
Assessment Type	☐ Coursework ☐ Examination ☐ In-class test ☒ Presentation ☐ Practical/Lab ☐ Other:
Last Updated	2026-27
Description	The students are required to present a strategic analysis of an organisation using relevant models and concepts covered in the module. The main aim is to apply appropriate tools and concepts to develop strategic options and practical, innovative solutions that address the organisation's challenges. Students should then make clear recommendations for the organisation's future strategy. Students must obtain approval from the lecturer for their chosen organisation. Therefore, the summative assessment will not be marked anonymously. The assessment will be completed in groups of four to five students. Groups may be formed by the students or assigned by the lecturer. Students are expected to remain in their originally allocated groups.

	The presentation should cover: • Strategic analysis and evaluation, including relevant external and internal analysis. • Strategic options and recommendations that logically follow from the analysis. • The innovation supporting the recommendations, such as product, process, business model, service or technological innovation. • Implementation considerations, including a clear implementation timeline. For organisations with multiple businesses, students may focus on one specific business area. Students are not expected to use every tool or framework covered in the textbook or module. They should select the tools and frameworks that are most relevant to their chosen organisation. The assessment will mainly consider the correct application of these tools and frameworks, as well as the quality of the supporting research and analysis. Recommendations will be assessed based on how clearly and logically they follow from the analysis. There are no fixed right or wrong recommendations. At Level 7, students are expected to integrate and critically evaluate complex evidence, exercise independent judgement, and communicate a clear and coherent strategic recommendation. Although this is a group presentation, 20 of the total 60 marks will be awarded for individual performance. This will be assessed through each student's contribution to the presentation and their performance during the question-and-answer session.
Submission date, time	The live presentation will be delivered in class during Week 8, according to the allocated presentation slot. PowerPoint slides must be uploaded to the module page on MyLearning at least 24 hours before the scheduled presentation.
Feedback type, frequency & date	Assessment briefing: Week 1. Formative work-in-progress feedback: Week 5. Mock presentation/formative feedback: Week 7. Summative feedback via MyLearning.
Word count (or equivalent)	20-25 minutes total: 15-minute group presentation + 5-10 minutes Q&A (3,500 words equivalent).

Assessed learning outcome(s) & evidence	LO1-LO4. Evidence is demonstrated through critical external/internal analysis, appropriate use and interpretation of strategic and innovation frameworks, evaluation of relevant trends and factors, coherent strategic recommendations, implementation reasoning, professional communication and teamwork.
Assessment weighting %	60%
Key reading and learning resources	Relevant MGT4952 module readings and learning materials in the module learning page and module handbook
Submission Method	Deliver the presentation in person during the allocated Week 8 slot. Upload final slides to the designated submission area by the submission date. Exact submission link to be added before release.
Assessment Criteria	1 Depth and breadth of research - 10% - use of appropriate information from recommended sources - use of current (to the extent possible), reliable and valid supplementary sources of information 2 External environment of the firm - 25%, including but not limited to: - general business environment - analysis of the firm's industry - competitor analysis (including firm's strategic group) 3 Internal Analysis of the firm - 25%, including but not limited to: - capabilities and resources - basis of competition (business-level strategy) - corporate-level strategy of the firm 4 Conclusions: Innovation Strategy and Implementation - 30% 5 Presentation - look & feel - 10% - visually attractive with an appropriate mix of text and visual forms of data presentation - meticulously referenced - written to a professional standard * *Subject to individual adjustment according to participation in presentation*
Use of GenAI Tools:	AMBER - Assisted scope. GenAI may be used in the development of the presentation and may contribute content that appears in the final presentation. Students remain responsible for accuracy, evidence, analysis and strategic judgement. All GenAI use must be acknowledged using the

	Record and Acknowledgement table, including the tool, date, purpose, representative prompts, validation checks and where/how the output was used. Factual claims and sources must be independently verified. Please refer to the University's AI policy
Middlesex Graduate Competencies	Tick the graduate competencies this assessment helps to develop and add a brief explanation of how: ☒ Leadership and Influence ☒ Curiosity and Learning ☒ Communication, Empathy and Inclusion ☒ Collaborative Innovation ☐ Entrepreneurial Mindset ☒ Problem Solving and Delivery ☐ Resilience and Adaptability ☒ Technological Agility

Guidance

Choosing an organisation for analysis

Each group should choose an organisation that:

- have sufficient current and reliable public information available for meaningful strategic analysis;
- operate in a clearly identifiable industry or strategic context;
- present a genuine strategic issue, challenge or opportunity that can support a substantive recommendation.

For diversified organisations, groups may focus on one clearly defined business unit or business area. Groups should submit their proposed organisation to the lecturer for approval before beginning detailed analysis. The same organisation may not be selected by more than one group within the same cohort; approval will therefore be on a first-confirmed basis.

1. Research

Start research using the sources of information introduced in class. Use appropriate databases and supplementary sources to fill missing details and bring the research up to date. Use current (to the extent possible), reliable and valid sources, including peer-reviewed journals, databases, government agencies, research think tanks and professional organisations. Major newspapers and magazines may also be used where appropriate.

Useful library resources: https://www.mdx.ac.ae/library/instructional-tutorials ; https://libguides.mdx.ac.uk/business_main

2. External Environment of the firm

Avoid making lists or taking a fill-in-the-blanks approach. Use an appropriate technique and include only the most significant factors. Do not rely on pre-made diagrams or analyses, even from reliable sources; conduct and evidence your own current analysis.

Integrate general-environment and industry-level evidence to demonstrate interpretation and evaluation. Competitor analysis should focus on relevant rivals and may consider products/services, market potential / commonality, positioning and strategic groups/key rivals.

Where appropriate, evaluate higher-value strategic questions such as distinctive value propositions and breakthrough innovation.

3. Internal Analysis of the firm

Use an appropriate technique to evaluate the firm's key capabilities and competitive resources and identify resources/capabilities that may underpin competitive advantage.

Identify and evaluate the firm's basis of competition and assess whether it is supported by capabilities/resources and competitive advantage within its strategic group.

Assess corporate-level strategy, including diversification, internationalisation, modes of growth (organic, acquisition or merger) and cooperative strategies where relevant, how appropriate this strategy given capabilities and resources.

4. Conclusion

Assume your audience is a group of busy senior executives, board members or investors. Your conclusion should therefore be concise, evidence-based and decision-oriented.

Synthesize the most important findings from your analysis. Clearly communicate:

- your overall judgement of the firm's strategic position;
- the most important strategic issues or opportunities requiring attention;
- your recommended innovation/strategic direction, showing how it follows logically from your analysis;
- the principal implementation priorities, risks and timeline; and
- where appropriate, the expected implications for competitive advantage, growth, performance or value creation.

5. Presentation

Treat the presentation as a strategic briefing. Prioritize insight over description, make the hierarchy of information immediately visible, and ensure each slide communicates a clear message. Avoid overcrowded slides and lengthy bullet lists.

Think carefully about how best to convey the information. Use concise executive-style visuals, charts, dashboards or summary frameworks where these communicate the message more

effectively than text. The audience should be able to understand what the evidence means, what decision you recommend and why.

Use accurate in-text citations and a complete reference list in the required Harvard format.

Edit and proofread carefully; use professional style, structure, visuals and alignment.

Assessment 1 Marking Rubric

Criteria	1-4 First	5-8 Upper Second	9-12 Lower Second	13-16 Third	17-20 Refer
	70%+	60%-69%	50%-59%	40%-49%	Less than 40%
Content: Topic chosen relevant and informative, with a depth of knowledge and understanding.	Excellent and well-in-formed understanding of theories and concepts involved with topic.	Good understanding of theories and concepts involved with topic.	Demonstrate satisfactory knowledge and under-standing of topics theories and concepts.	Adequate content, and limited depth of knowledge and under-standing.	Inadequate content and limited depth of knowledge and under-standing.
Communication: Interesting, relevant language, explanation of terminology.	Very well expressed and very good understanding of content.	Very well expressed; good understanding of content.	Well expressed; understanding of content.	Unclear ex-pression of information; little under-standing of content.	Unclear and confusing; lack of understanding of content.
References: Reference to sources including directions for further study.	Broad and relevant readings examined and used selectively in presentation	Good range of appropriate references used during the presentation	Conventional references and readings used within presentation	Adequate but limited use of references during presentation.	Critique relies on no or one reference; evidence of un-examined personal opinion.
Technology: Use of video, PowerPoint, tools etc. to pre-send the chosen topic.	Very good selection, use and integration of technology.	Good use of appropriate AV.	Technology used but poor integration.	Technology is used but poorly.	Absence of any technology use.
Workload: Balance between students.	All students share presentation role equally with good transition.	Presentation shared but with poor transition.	Presentation shared unequally.	Presentation shows little sharing.	No sharing, one student presents.

Part 2 – 40%

Assessment Title	Individual Reflection
Assessment Type	☒ Coursework ☐ Examination ☐ In-class test ☐ Presentation ☐ Practical/Lab ☐ Other:
Last Updated	2026-27
Description	Students are required to write a 1,000-word individual reflection on how their understanding of strategy and innovation developed across the module. Students should consider their learning journey as a whole and identify the experiences, ideas, discussions, cases, activities or moments that most influenced how they now understand strategic analysis, decision-making, implementation and innovation. Students are encouraged to keep a reflective journal throughout the module. This may be maintained privately or, where appropriate, through the module discussion board. The journal is intended to help students capture their thinking as it develops and does not itself form part of the summative assessment. The reflection should demonstrate how students' thinking and understanding of strategy evolved over time, why it evolved, and what consequences this has for future judgement and practice. Students should identify important learning moments, tensions, surprises, assumptions that were challenged, and connections between different parts of the module and programme as well as team dynamics and interactions when preparing group presentations for Assessment 1. The emphasis is on making the learning trajectory visible. Students may draw on a recognised reflective framework where useful and are encouraged to use an appropriate visuals to communicate their learning journey where this adds value (e.g. a learning map, timeline, concept map, strategy journey, before-and-after model). Visuals should support the critical reflection and should be referred to in the written discussion.
Submission date, time	End of Week 8 via MyLearning.
Feedback type, frequency & date	Assessment briefing: Week 2 Formative work-in-progress feedback: Week 5 and 7. Summative feedback via MyLearning.
Word count (or equivalent)	1000 words

Assessed learning outcome(s) & evidence	LO1-LO4. Evidence is demonstrated through critical reflection on the student's own learning experiences, explicit connections to strategy and innovation learning, personal insights supported by specific examples, and a clear action plan for future personal/professional development.
Assessment weighting %	40%
Key reading and learning resources	Relevant MGT4952 module readings and learning materials in my learning page and module handbook.
Submission Method	Submit the individual written reflective statement to the designated submission area by the submission date. Exact submission link to be added before release.
Assessment Criteria	Introduction – 10%; Reflection supported by examples and appropriate detail – 40%; Conclusions with clear personal development goals – 35%; Technical proficiency in English and professional presentation – 15%. See Marking Rubric for details.
Use of GenAI Tools:	RED - No scope for GenAI. GenAI is not permitted in the development or creation of outputs (except assistive technology via reasonable adjustment). The GenAI acknowledgement table is therefore not applicable unless specifically authorised.
Middlesex Graduate Competencies	Tick the graduate competencies this assessment helps to develop and add a brief explanation of how: ☒ Leadership and Influence ☒ Curiosity and Learning ☒ Communication, Empathy and Inclusion ☐ Collaborative Innovation ☐ Entrepreneurial Mindset ☒ Problem Solving and Delivery ☒ Resilience and Adaptability ☐ Technological Agility

Guidance

This assessment is a reflection on the learning journey across the module which in-cludes but not limited to in-class lectures and activities, individual readings and research per-formed during the module, group work, peer interactions. A strong submission should:

- identify significant learning moments, ideas, discussions, cases or activities that influenced the student's understanding of strategy and innovation;
- demonstrate development over time, showing how initial assumptions, perspectives or ways of thinking changed as the module progressed;
- make meaningful connections between different topics, readings and experiences across the module;
- move beyond description and draw appropriately on relevant concepts, theories or frameworks from the module where these help interpret the learning experience;
- use specific examples from the student's own learning journey to support the reflection;
- consider the implications of the learning for future professional practice, strategic decision-making and personal development;
- identify what the student might think, decide or do differently in future as a result of the learning;
- use of one of the reflective frameworks (e.g. Kolb's, Gibbs', Driscoll's) for a clear and coherent structure is highly encouraged.
- It is strongly recommended to maintain a brief reflective journal throughout the module to capture changing ideas, questions, reactions and learning moments while they are still fresh. The journal may be kept privately or through the module discussion board. It is in-tended as a learning aid and does not itself form part of the summative assessment.

Assessment 2 Marking Rubric

Criteria	1-4 First	5-8 Upper Second	9-12 Lower Second	13-16 Third	17-20 Refer
	70%+	60%-69%	50%-59%	40%-49%	Less than 40%
Introduction – 10%	Provides a clear, focused and insightful introduction to learning journey, identifying significant themes and establishing the student's starting perspective on strategy and innovation.	Clearly establishes the context and scope of the learning journey, identifying key themes, experiences and the student's initial understanding.	Most elements of the practice and/or the identification of a reflective model used for the reflection.	Some elements of the practice and/or the identification of a reflective model used for the reflection.	Missing most elements of the practice and identification of the reflective model used for the reflection.
Reflection – 40% - supported by examples; correct amount of detail.	Demonstrates sophisticated and critical meta-reflection, showing clearly how and why the student's thinking evolved over time, with strong integration of module learning, specific experiences, and implications.	Demonstrates deep and critical reflection on how the student's thinking developed over time, supported by learning experiences.	Demonstrates satisfactory knowledge and understanding of reflections.	Adequate content with limited depth of reflection and limited understanding of process.	Inadequate content with limited depth of reflection and limited understanding of process.
Conclusions – 35% - conclusions with clear personal development goals.	Expert conclusion and identification of future goals.	Undertakes a systematic analysis and identifies future goals.	Clearly expressed with observable structure with limited future goals.	Expression is reasonably clear, but analysis is unclear and goals unrealistic.	Poorly structured and poorly expressed future goals.
Technical proficiency in the English language and professional presentation - 15% - clearly presented with limited spelling and grammatical errors.	Very well expressed and understanding of content with limited spelling or grammatical errors	Very well expressed; good understanding of content with some spelling and/or grammatical errors.	Well expressed; understanding of content with many spelling and/or gram-grammatical errors.	Simple expression of information; little understanding of content; many spelling and grammatical errors.	Inaccurate expression of information; lacks understanding of content; many spelling and grammatical errors.

2.4 Academic Integrity and Misconduct

Academic integrity means producing your work in a transparent way, based on valid academic and professional sources, properly referenced and with any assistance fully acknowledged.

Note: Compliance with the Academic Integrity and Misconduct Policy is a condition of enrolment. Students are responsible for ensuring that they are fully aware of, and adhere to, the requirements set out in the Policy.

Academic Misconduct is a breach of the values of academic integrity, and can occur when a student cheats in an assessment, or attempts to deliberately mislead an examiner that the work presented is their own when it is not. It includes, but is not limited to, plagiarism, self-plagiarism, commissioning or buying work from a third party or copying the work of others, breach of examination rules, collusion etc.

- **Plagiarism** – using extensive unacknowledged quotations from, or direct copying of, another person's work and presenting it for assessment as if it were your own effort.
- **Purchasing or Commissioning -** This includes the use of third party essay writing services. Essay mills are now illegal entities and use of them is facilitating an illegal activity.
- **Collusion** – working together with other students (without the tutor's permission) and presenting similar or identical work for assessment.
- **Self-Plagiarism** – including any material which is identical or substantially similar to material that has already been submitted by you for another assessment in the University or elsewhere.
- **Unauthorised use of Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI)** – using GenAI without appropriate acknowledgement and referencing. Appropriate use of GenAI is detailed the AI in Learning and Teaching Policy.

To support your academic integrity, please refer to the Referencing guidance and ensure your referencing meets your discipline's required standards.

Our Library and the Centre for Academic Success (CAS) run workshops and clinics to help you learn how to avoid plagiarism and how to reference correctly. To get support and guidance on academic writing techniques that meet our expectations of Academic Integrity, please contact a staff member in CAS.

Student Success Essentials (an online self-study course available via MyLearning) includes useful information about how to approach your assessments and complete them with honesty. The course also describes what plagiarism (cheating) is and how to avoid it, so you don't face any action due to violation of academic integrity rules.

The Dubai Academic Integrity and Misconduct Team (aim@mdx.ac.ae) provide guidance on responding to allegations of academic misconduct and its related processes.

2.5 Appropriate use of GenAI

This table defines the different levels of scope you may be given to use GenAI in your assessed work. Your Assessment Brief above defines which level applies to that assessment task and will include further guidance and support.

GenAI Scope in Assessment	What it means
RED – No scope	GenAI is not permitted in the development or creation of out-puts (except assistive technology via reasonable adjustment). Assessments in this category can include exams, Vivas/inter-views, and professional / regulatory competencies where GenAI is out of scope.
AMBER – Assistive scope	Assistive use is permitted only within defined parameters for assessment preparation and process, such as: summarizing sources, connecting ideas/themes, self-test and revision prompts, spelling and grammar support in drafts, support for data analysis, project planning and management. GenAI should not be used to produce entire sections of text or elements of media that appear in the final submission.
GREEN– Inte-grated Scope	Integrated use: GenAI can be used to create content that ap-pears in the final submission. GenAI can be used at multiple stages of the assessment process. GenAI use must be acknowledged and/or cited, and assessments may ask for student commentary and critical evaluation of its use.

2.6 Record and Acknowledgement of GenAI Use

Use this table to record how you have used GenAI for this assessment. It will help you keep track of the tools and prompts you used, reflect on your learning, and explain your study choices if needed - for example in tutorials, group work, reflections, or reflective and methodological sections of your work.

	Details and Explanation
GenAI tools used	*e.g. MS Copilot, ChatGPT, Midjourney, Perplexity, etc.*
Date of use	*e.g. 15/07/2026*
Amber or Green Category & Purpose of use	*e.g. Amber – spell checking; Green – to suggest an outline essay structure.*
Examples of prompts used (keep a log of all your prompts saved)	*e.g. "Generate ideas for structuring an essay on the themes of..."*

How did you check the validity of the GenAI suggestions?	*e.g. Cross-checked against reading list materials; Google Scholar; discussion with tutor.*
The section or phase of assessment where GenAI was used	*e.g. Planning project work; finding themes in data; producing an outline structure; checking draft sections for grammar; integrating and evaluating GenAI output in final work.*

2.7 Micro-course: Foundations of AI Literacy

Students are expected to complete the micro-course on 'Foundations of AI Literacy' on MyLearning to empower yourself with the basic skills you will need to navigate the rapidly changing landscape of generative artificial intelligence. This micro course has lessons that will equip you with essential skills to understand AI, evaluate AI generated content to make informed judgement about tools you encounter and use AI responsibly as part of your student journey. This micro course can be completed within 90 minutes. You can expect to learn through:

- Completely free and accessible bite-sized content based on the latest guidelines from thought leaders at UNESCO, IBM, Google, OpenAI, and Anthropic
- Core AI literacy concepts written by leading academics and our information literacy experts in the library
- Progressing at your own pace using self-study materials and interactive content, including videos, case-studies, quizzes, and interactive activities
- Upon completing the micro-course, you will be awarded a certificate of completion.

What does this micro-course cover?

Unit 1. Understand: AI and ethical aspects: This unit introduces the fundamental differences between AI and Generative AI, emphasizing the role of data in AI applications. It also addresses key ethical concerns related to AI-generated content.

Unit 2. Evaluate: Judgement and responsible use: This unit focuses on evaluating AI-generated output to identify bias and hallucinations, while developing the skills required to use AI responsibly. It also provides guidance on evaluating AI tools from an ethical perspective in academic contexts.

Unit 3. Use: Prompting skills and use of tools: This unit explores frameworks and approaches to help you develop effective prompting skills. It also examines the type of tasks best suited to popular AI tools and their applications in academic and research contexts.

Students can register on this course via the Library.

2.8 Support that is available to you

Support and draft feedback sessions for *Assessments*
Coursework briefing *Briefings will take place in class during Weeks 1 and 2*
Sample assignments

Examples will be discussed in Class

Draft feedback opportunities

Students may receive feedback on their work in progress during dedicated time in class during week 5, with opportunity for mock presentations in week 7.

Additional support

- Lecturer Consultation: can be requested by prior appointment by sending an email to your lecturer
- MyMDX: https://mdx.mrooms.net/course/view.php?id=45668
- CiteThemRight: offers online help for referencing at: http://www.citethemrightonline.com.ezproxy.mdx.ac.uk
- Centre for Academic Success (CAS) Consultation: you have the option to book individual consultations or group appointments with members of the CAS Team. These sessions have been known to help students reach their academic goals through one-on-one consultations with our highly professional and helpful CAS team members. For more information on the services offered by the CAS Team, or to book an individual consultation, you may send an email to CAS@mdx.ac.ae or visit https://www.mdx.ac.ae/cas
- Instructional Resources: The Library offers many instructional resources via their website: https://www.mdx.ac.ae/library where students can learn how to use the library and its resources by watching videos, using interactive tools, and exploring Library Guides – which provides students with the information necessary to understand how to access books, eBooks, Journals, articles, databases, conference proceedings, research results, etc.
- Liaison Librarians – Students are encouraged to contact their Liaison Librarian who can provide expert individual or group assistance finding materials for specific assignments, give research support and direction, and provide general Library guidance: https://www.mdx.ac.ae/library/liaison-librarians
- An Introduction to the Research Process: This online course is specifically designed to introduce Middlesex University Dubai students to the five steps of the Research Process. The course can assist with getting started on research for an essay, term paper, presentation, or dissertation by providing guidance on locating Library and web resources including books, articles and eBooks. https://www.mdx.ac.ae/library/an-introduction-to-the-research-process
- Library Focus: Students are encouraged to register for Library Focus workshops. Library Focus workshops develop research skills and help students best utilise Library resources
- Further teaching and learning support materials can be found on the Dubai Teaching and Learning Support MyMDX page that includes short videos, tutorials, etc produced by the CAS and Library teams. https://mdx.mrooms.net/course/view.php?id=24990

Assessment support for students of determination

Students who have declared special needs or learning differences or an ongoing medical condition may contact the Inclusion Counsellor in the Centre for Academic Success. This will set out the reasonable additional support that will be put in place by the University to assist that student's learning and assessment. It is the student's responsibility to make arrangements and follow the procedures set by the Centre of Academic Success in order for reasonable adjustments to be put in place. This may

include the option to take up to 5 calendar days late submission on individual written coursework without having a grade reduction. Check the Middlesex University's Policy and Procedures for Extenuating Circumstances Claims 2025-2026 for more information.

2.9 Feedback on your assignments

Students receive helpful and informative feedback on all assessments to support their learning and development. Feedback may be provided in various forms, including written comments, tutorial feedback (individual or group), peer feedback, or other appropriate methods. Formative or draft assessments will receive feedback but no grade, and comments will highlight strengths as well as areas for improvement. All assignments should be submitted online unless stated otherwise in the assessment brief.

Feedback on summative assessments will normally be provided within 15 working days of the published submission date.

3. Results Confirmation

3.1 How is your assignment mark agreed?

The following diagram provides an overview of the marking process for your module assessment:

Step 1	You submit your assignment
Step 2	The first marker grades the work* and provides feedback; this could be completed anonymously depending on the assessment type.
Step 3	A moderator or second marker reviews a sample of the work to ensure the consistency of the grades and feedback. A final mark for the work is agreed between the first marker and the moderator or second marker.
Step 4	A sample of work, from a selection of modules across the programme, is reviewed by the External Examiner to check that the grading and feedback is at the right level and in line with external subject benchmarks (this applies to levels 5,6 &7 only).
Step 5	Your final grades are submitted to the Programme assessment board.

***Provisional Grades:** At the end of your first semester, you can see your module grades in the Grades and Progress tile within MyMDX. These grades are provisional and not yet confirmed by the Programme Assessment Board.

Final Grades and Progression: After your second semester, the Programme Assessment Board will confirm your grades. Then, your final module results, progression status, or finalist classification will be posted in the Grades and Progress tile within MyMDX.

Each assessment component will be marked in percentages. However, the overall module grade will be calculated using the University 20-point scale:

20-point scale	General scale	General scale (full ranges)
1	80% - 100%	79.50% - 100%
2	76% - 79%	75.50% - 79.49%
3	73% - 75%	72.50% - 75.49%
4	70% - 72%	69.50% - 72.49%
5	67% - 69%	66.50% - 69.49%
6	65% - 66%	64.50% - 66.49%
7	62% - 64%	61.50% - 64.49%
8	60% - 61%	59.50% - 61.49%
9	57% - 59%	56.50% - 59.49%
10	55% - 56%	54.50% - 56.49%
11	52% - 54%	51.50% - 54.49%
12	50% - 51%	49.50% - 51.49%
13	47% - 49%	46.50% - 49.49%
14	45% - 46%	44.50% - 46.49%
15	42% - 44%	41.50% - 44.49%
16	40% - 41%	39.50% - 41.49%
17	35% - 39%	34.50% - 39.49%
18	30% - 34%	29.50% - 34.49%
19	0% - 29%	0.01% - 29.49%
20	Non-participation	0%

For more information visit the MyMDX Assessment FAQ page or reach out to Campus Central via AskMDX.

3.3 Extenuating Circumstances

Students must submit each component of assessment by the deadline set by the Module Leader/Coordinator. If circumstances beyond your control affect your ability to meet an assessment deadline or perform well, these may be considered extenuating circumstances (ECs). If you find yourself in this situation, there are academic tools available to you to help you manage your studies. Please visit the MyMDX Extenuating Circumstances and Late Submission page for more information.

For individual written coursework only, late submission of up to 24 hours from the deadline is permissible, however, the grade for the component is reduced by 10% or equivalent (or less where this would reduce a pass grade below 40%). Students should take into consideration the impact this will have on their deadline schedule and their final grades before selecting this option.

Extenuating Circumstances can only be requested for summative assessment, not for formative assessment. For example, only for assessment that counts towards your overall module grade.

Students **MUST** provide evidence/supporting statement with any request for extenuating circumstances to be considered (except in cases of self-certification*) for a deferral to the next assessment opportunity, or for Extenuating Circumstances to be noted at the Programme Assessment board.

*__Self-certification__ can only be used when an extenuating circumstance **has affected you for period of 7 days or less**, i.e. a short illness that occurs at the point of assessment submission. You can apply for the following outcomes due to your Extenuating Circumstances. Please note the outcome of any Extenuating Circumstances application may be different from what has been requested:

Deferral	Your circumstances have impacted on your ability to sit your exam or complete and/or submit your assessment. You are requesting an opportunity to sit the exam or submit the work at the next assessment opportunity
ECs noted for the board only	Your circumstances may have affected your performance on other assessments for one or more modules and, although you have sat the exam or submitted the assessments, you wish the Programme Assessment Board to be aware of this in case there is a borderline decision to be made regarding your progression/finalist decision.
Deferral & ECs noted for the Board	Your circumstances have impacted on your ability to sit your exam or complete and/or submit your assessment. You are requesting an opportunity to sit the exam or submit the work at the next assessment opportunity.

Note: There could be progression (i.e. additional year(s) of study), financial (tuition fees and scholarships) and student visa implications as a result of deferring your assessment.

For more information on how to apply for Extenuating Circumstances, please check the dedicated webpage or contact CampusCentral via AskMDX.

4. Expectations of Studying

Students are expected to actively participate in both online and on-campus learning, behave professionally, and engage respectfully, professionally and in a supportive manner with peers, tutors, and staff. They should come prepared for classes and communicate courteously in all University-related interactions, including email.

Students must familiarise themselves with the Campus Guide and University Regulations, which outline key policies, services, procedures, rights, responsibilities, and standards of conduct. Compliance with these requirements is expected throughout their time at Middlesex University Dubai and for the duration of their enrolment.

4.1 Attendance and Engagement

Regulations regarding attendance can be found on the University Regulations. In accordance with University Regulation for taught programmes of study, it is the responsibility of students to attend scheduled classes and prescribed activities for the modules on which they are registered.

Students should attend and engage with all scheduled classes and prescribed activities. Studies have shown that a good student engagement has a positive impact on performance and therefore is an important factor

in helping you to fulfil your academic potential. In addition, for those who are on student visas, Dubai's regulatory authorities require attendance to be monitored.

Lecturers maintain attendance records during scheduled teaching sessions using the MDX Dubai App. Students are expected to follow any guidelines and instructions provided for the proper recording of attendance during learning sessions.

The MDX Dubai App (available on iOS and Android) allows students to register attendance at timetabled classes. To record attendance:

1. Connect to the internet using the **#mdxDUBAI** Wi-Fi network.
2. Open the MDX Dubai App.
3. Log in using a Campus User ID (M0xxxxxxx@studentmdx.ac) and password.
4. Ensure that permission has been granted for the MDX Dubai App to access the smartphone's location and camera settings.
5. Locate the correct module and timetabled class via the Calendar.
6. When the lecturer or tutor displays the class QR code, use the scanner within the MDX App to scan the code.
7. An automated notification will appear within the App confirming that attendance has been recorded.

Middlesex University Dubai supports students in achieving their full potential through a range of strategies designed to provide a supportive learning environment. Online support material on MyMDX is provided as a guide to class content but is no substitute for interaction with tutors and classmates. Students experiencing difficulties beyond their control that prevent engagement with a module should notify their tutor and Campus Central, who may be able to offer support and guidance.

Note: Where your attendance and engagement fail to meet the minimum levels required (normally **75%** of scheduled learning sessions and activities but could be higher) to attain the learning outcomes of the module, you may be excluded from the assessment. You may have the opportunity to retake the whole module with permission from the Campus Programme Coordinator/ Leader, without grade penalty, though you will have to pay the relevant additional tuition fees for the module re-registration.

4.2 Recording Lectures

As per the University Regulations unauthorised audio recording, video recording or photography of lectures, or other forms of learning activities by students, is prohibited.

Limited recording by students may be permitted under exceptional circumstances only (for example, for an individual student as a "reasonable adjustment", within the meaning of the UK's Equalities Act), upon explicit permission provided by the tutor and, where appropriate, by everyone else involved. Permission for recording does not imply permission for publication (e.g. Instagram, YouTube, or other Social Media), or distribution to others. Unauthorised recording of such activities violates the privacy of persons involved, may infringe on copyrights and intellectual property rights of others and can be intrusive and disruptive in a learning environment. In all cases, violation of this regulation will be managed under the student disciplinary procedures.

In addition to a violation of University Regulations, unauthorised recordings may expose students to other unintended consequences, as per UAE law. The United Arab Emirates has several laws (for example, Federal

Decree Law No. 34 of 2021 on Combatting Rumours and Cybercrimes) for the protection of privacy and reputation and defamation. Some of the acts that could amount to a criminal offence are:

- possessing on an electronic device a photo taken without the subject's consent
- posting other people's pictures or videos online or on social media (including WhatsApp) without their consent
- tagging a person without their consent
- threatening or insulting people online
- spreading information via social media, that is not verified by the official sources
- gossiping about people or maligning them.

4.3 Laptops, Mobile Phones and Other Devices

Technology can enhance learning in higher education when used responsibly. Students are encouraged to use laptops, tablets, mobile phones, and other devices for learning activities, and tutors may require them in some sessions. When not being used for class activities, devices should be on silent or airplane mode. Calls, texts, and social media should be avoided unless approved by the tutor. Disruptive use of devices may result in removal from class and disciplinary action.

4.4 Professional Behaviour

Students must come to sessions prepared and ready to contribute where appropriate.

University Student ID cards must be carried at all times while on campus, and students must be able to identify themselves when requested. Students must also comply with community health precautions and other health and safety protocols.

Communication with fellow students, tutors, and University staff, including email correspondence, must be conducted in a professional, formal, and courteous manner.

Unacceptable Behaviours in Face-to-Face Interactions

- Aggressive or abusive behaviour, including shouting, bullying behaviour, physical violence, rudeness, and making threats, inappropriate gestures, or indecent comments
- Persistently interrupting or disrupting learning activities and events
- Engaging in antisocial behaviour that impacts others
- Making derogatory or discriminatory remarks about others
- Using offensive language or engaging in personal verbal attacks
- Discussing sensitive matters in public settings
- Making unsupported claims that the University or individual staff have committed criminal, corrupt, biased or perverse conduct without any evidence
- Demanding that staff set aside or make exceptions to University regulations
- Demanding responses within an unreasonable timescale or insisting on seeing specific staff members when not feasible
- Refusing to accept outcomes or solutions offered or repeatedly seeking further explanations without new information or evidence

Actions to be taken by the University or Staff

- Highlight the unacceptable behaviour(s) and explain why and what effect it is having
- Pause or end the discussion or interaction if the unacceptable behaviour remains persistent

- In serious cases, ask for removal of individuals from University facilities and report the incident to relevant Dubai authorities
- Restrict personal contact and require communication via email or written channels and/or through third parties
- Referral to appropriate disciplinary procedures

Version Control

Disclaimer: The material in this document is as accurate as possible at the date of production; however, you will be informed of any major changes in a timely manner.

Version	Date	Author	Updates	Approved by
1.0	02.09.2026	Institutional Planning and Quality Office (IPQO)	Added Dubai Specific information	Senior Officer
2.0	07.09.2026	Senior Management Team and IPQO	Refinement	Deputy Director